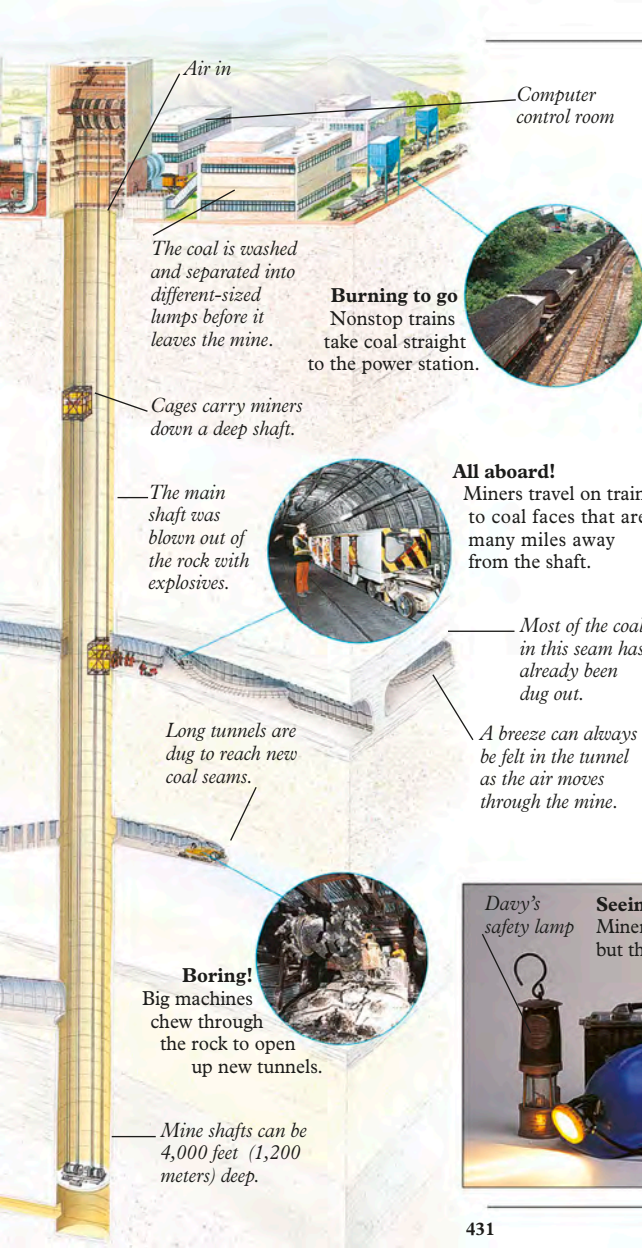




The coal is washed and separated into different-sized lumps before it leaves the mine.

Burning to go
Nonstop trains take coal straight to the power station.



Cages carry miners down a deep shaft.

The main shaft was blown out of the rock with explosives.



Long tunnels are dug to reach new coal seams.

Boring!
Big machines chew through the rock to open up new tunnels.



Mine shafts can be 4,000 feet (1,200 meters) deep.

All aboard!

Miners travel on trains to coal faces that are many miles away from the shaft.

Most of the coal in this seam has already been dug out.

A breeze can always be felt in the tunnel as the air moves through the mine.

Down to earth

Not all coal is the same. Hard coals, which are found deeper underground, release more energy when they burn.



Half-squashed coal, or peat, is made into fuel bricks.



Soft, crumbly brown coal is burned to make coke.



Black bituminous coal is burned to generate electricity.



Anthracite coal is used in houses and factories.

Davy's safety lamp

Seeing the light

Miners once worked by candlelight, but the flames often set fire to the explosive gases that build up in tunnels. In 1815, a safety lamp was invented. Its flame was kept behind a wire mesh. Modern lamps are even safer, as they are battery powered.

